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HOWARD REID

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Executive with 27+ years of experience leading enterprise IT strategy, infrastructure modernization, cloud transformation, and cybersecurity across private equity portfolios and large enterprise environments. Proven leader in Azure cloud migrations, Zero Trust security, ITSM, M&A integration, and enterprise operations with ownership of $10M+ IT budgets. Recognized for delivering measurable cost savings, strengthening security posture, and aligning technology with business outcomes.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

FOUNDER & PRODUCT TECHNOLOGY LEAD **Sep 2025 - Present**
Pantry Tab LLC ***North Richland Hills, Tx***

Founded and launched a subscription-based SaaS platform that automates grocery inventory, recipe planning, and household management using modern cloud and AI workflows.

Key Contributions

- Led end-to-end product strategy, design, and launch of a consumer SaaS platform.
- Designed scalable cloud architecture with strong security, privacy, and data-protection practices.
- Implemented AI-driven automation workflows to improve user experience and reduce manual data entry.
- Established subscription billing, compliance, and customer-data governance processes.
- Built marketing automation and analytics workflows to track adoption and engagement.
- Managed branding, pricing model, legal policies, and go-to-market strategy.

Impact

- Live SaaS platform demonstrating leadership across product development, cloud architecture, security governance, and operations.
- Strengthened hands-on expertise in modern SaaS, AI, and subscription business models relevant digital transformation initiatives

STRATEGIC ADVISOR, BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT & IT OPERATIONS **May 2025 - Feb 2026**
Blue Star Equity Group ***Fort Worth, TX***

- Provide strategic, operational, and technology advisory services across a multi-company private equity portfolio.
- Guide IT modernization, cybersecurity governance, and scalable operating models.
- Align technology investments with growth, risk management, and financial performance.

IT OPERATIONS CONSULTANT **Oct 2024 - Apr 2025**
DreidHQ Capital LLC ***Fort Worth, TX***

- Delivered IT, automation, and operational consulting for an investment and trading organization.
- Designed secure file architectures and reporting workflows.
- Improved documentation, governance, and operational processes.

DIRECTOR OF INFRASTRUCTURE, IT SECURITY, OPERATIONS & END USER COMPUTING **Jun 2023 - Aug 2024**
Liberty Steel USA ***Peoria, IL / Dallas, TX***

- Led enterprise IT infrastructure, security, and operations across U.S. manufacturing sites.
- Managed $15M+ IT budget while reducing costs by 35%.
- Established formal IT Security organization aligned to Zero Trust principles.
- Implemented IAM, MFA, penetration testing, ITSM (FreshService), and HR-integrated automation.

SENIOR DIRECTOR OF IT STRATEGY & ARCHITECTURE **May 2021 - Jun 2023**
Wilks Brothers LLC ***Fort Worth, TX***

- Provided enterprise IT leadership across a 27+ company private equity portfolio.
- Managed $12M IT budget.
- Led Azure migrations delivering $750K annual savings.
- Directed data center consolidation of 165+ servers.
- Reduced telecom costs by $400K annually.

DIRECTOR OF IT OPERATIONS & ENTERPRISE SOLUTIONS **May 2014 - May 2021**
Wilks Brothers LLC ***Fort Worth, TX***

- Executed M&A technology integrations achieving $5M+ in annual cost synergies.
- Established PMO and IT Service Desk.
- Reduced cybersecurity incidents by 85%.
- Achieved 100% MFA adoption.
- Cut device provisioning time from 6 hours to 35 minutes.

MANAGER OF CLIENT SERVICES **Nov 2010 - May 2014**
FTS International ***Fort Worth, TX***

CLIENT SERVICES TEAM MANAGER **May 2007 - Nov 2010**
Capgemini Energy / HCL America ***Dallas, TX***

IT CLIENT SUPPORT **Sep 2002 - Oct 2006**
YellowBook USA ***King of Prussia, PA***

IT INFRASTRUCTURE SUPPORT **Sep 1997 - Apr 2002**
Northwest Texas Healthcare System ***Amarillo, TX***

EDUCATION

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE, IT NETWORK ADMINISTRATION
Western Governors University

COURSES

ITIL V3

COMPTIA SECURITY+

COMPTIA PROJECT+

LEAN SIX SIGMA WHITE BELT

CAPM (IN PROGRESS) - EXAM SCHEDULED IN MARCH

SKILLS

IT Strategy & Architecture, Infrastructure & Cloud (Azure), Cybersecurity & Zero Trust, Identity & Access Management (IAM, MFA), IT Operations & ITSM, Mergers & Acquisitions (M&A), PMO Establishment, Budget & Vendor Management, Executive & Board Partnership, Enterprise Transformation, Team Leadership & Mentorship.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY
Lead Goalkeeper Coach

- Solar Soccer Club (ECNL-RL)
- Hurst United
- Allegiance Academy